

INFRASTRUCTURE THE NEW SILVER BULLET?

Roop Narayan Sunkar,
Member (Infrastructure), Railway Board

LEARNING FROM THE BEST

Japan's assistance in India's bullet train project is a fillip for India's high-speed rail ambitions

The Centre plans to commence trials for India's bullet train project in June 2026, says **Roop Narayan Sunkar**, Member (Infrastructure), Railway Board. Upon the completion of the trials, India may be in a position to run the train in a selected stretch in the same year.

A JOINT COLLABORATION

There were hiccups initially. For land acquisition, there were a large number of issues. There were issues related to ownership, environment, forest clearances, other strategic clearances, and so on. But now, land acquisition issues are over. Almost 99 per cent of the land is available with us now.

For civil engineering works, we have awarded the contract for an entire stretch of 508 km. Of this, 352 km is in Gujarat, for which work is progressing at a faster pace as the contracts were awarded much earlier. And the progress made so far is so good that the foundation work for almost 300 km is done.

Japanese systems are very stringent too. They don't relax any standards, and it is good for us. It is basically a learning for us, we are changing our mindset. ■

CULINARY CROSSOVER

From matching Japanese whiskies with Indian delicacies to a critique of fusion food from the two nations, experts have a say on a myriad of delectable topics

A JAPANESE WONDER

Sandeep Arora: Japanese themselves, for a long time, really didn't feel very comfortable with their own whiskies. But that was way back. They have taken a pole position when it comes to whiskies. Japanese whiskies are crafted around nature, sun, season and temperance. All the flavours are so robust and rich that they go absolutely sublime with great food, not just Japanese food but even Indian food. I'm not too confident of a rogan josh or a butter chicken as yet, but definitely, a lot of sublime flavours will go with whiskies. They're very confident whiskies. They're not easy to give up, and they will be persistent, like the Japanese to keep pairing and evolving the pairing platform.

THE FUSION CONFUSION

Suvir Saran: The Japanese work very hard in creating purity of flavour, and purity of experience. They spend lifetimes perfecting things. In India, we are in a fusion

THE CONSUMER



"JAPANESE FIRMS CAN BECOME THE NO. 1 CHOICE FOR INDIAN CONSUMERS CONSCIOUS ABOUT THE TOTAL COST OF OWNERSHIP AND FACTORS SUCH AS TRUST, SAFETY, CRAFTSMANSHIP AND RELIABILITY"

MANISH SHARMA
Chairman, Panasonic Life Solutions, India and South Asia